

VentureMiner AI

Customer Support Guide

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Document 33 — Customer Support Guide

How we support customers — from first ticket to resolution, with tier-specific SLAs and the playbooks for the issues we see most.

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1. Purpose & Scope

This document is the contract for customer support. It governs:

- The support channels (in-app, email, chat, phone).
- SLAs by tier.
- The ticket lifecycle and severity model.
- The playbooks for the most common issues.
- Escalation paths into engineering.

It does not cover sales (Document 32) or customer success motions (Section 11).

2. Support principles

1. The customer is the source of truth. Their description of the problem is real, even if our logs disagree.
2. One owner. Every ticket has one assigned person.
3. ~~Communicate first, fix second. Update before you ship.~~

3. Channels

Help center	✓	✓	✓	✓
Community forum	✓	✓	✓	✓
Email	—	✓ (48h)	✓ (8h)	✓ (4h)
In-app chat	—	—	✓ (8h)	✓ (1h)
Phone	—	—	—	✓ (1h)
Dedicated CSM	—	—	—	✓
Slack Connect	—	—	—	✓ (Enterprise)

4. SLAs by tier

Free	48h business hours	Best-effort
Solo	48h business hours	5 business days
Team	8h business hours	2 business days
Enterprise	1h business hours, 24x7 for SEV-1	1 business day (SEV-1: 4h)

5. Ticket lifecycle

New → Triaged → In Progress → Waiting on Customer → Resolved → Closed

- New — customer submitted.
- Triaged — severity assigned, owner assigned.
- In Progress — actively being worked.
- Waiting on Customer — needs more info; auto-reminded after 5 days.
- Resolved — fix shipped or workaround provided; auto-closed after 7 days.
- Closed — terminal.

6. Severity model

SEV-1	Service down; data loss; security incident	Login broken; reports failing	Page on-call; < 1h response
SEV-2	Significant degradation; major feature broken	Discovery returns 0 hits; export fails	< 4h response
SEV-3	Limited impact; workaround exists	Specific report type errors; UI bug	< 24h response
SEV-4	Cosmetic / minor	Typo; dark mode glitch	< 1 week

7. Common issues & playbooks

7.1 "My report failed mid-run"

1. Check run status in the agent observability dashboard.
2. Capture run_id; check partial findings.
3. If transient → re-run.
4. If persistent → check source health; escalate to AI on-call.

7.2 "The score doesn't match my expectation"

1. Show the score breakdown + rationale + citations.
2. If the rubric is custom → explain how the dimension was scored.
3. Offer a manual override (Document 09 §17).
4. If a calibration issue → tag for monthly calibration review.

7.3 "I'm being charged for overages I didn't expect"

1. Pull the usage record.
2. Explain how the cap works.
3. Offer a plan upgrade or overage pack.
4. Refund if our metering is wrong.

7.4 "I can't log in"

1. Check Auth0 logs.
2. Reset password or magic link.
3. If SSO issue → engage the customer's IdP admin.
4. If MFA issue → walk through recovery.

7.5 "The citation is wrong / outdated"

1. Show the chunk and the source URL.
2. If our index is stale → trigger a re-fetch.
3. If the source itself is wrong → file a source-quality ticket.
4. Re-screenshot the report.

7.6 "I want to delete my data"

1. Verify identity.
2. Trigger account deletion (Document 29 §9).
3. Confirm within 30 days.

7.7 "My source isn't being included"

1. Check the source is enabled in workspace settings.
2. Check source health (rate limit, error rate).
3. If the source is failing → escalate; if it's expected to fail → notify user.

8. Escalation paths

Auth / billing	Auth on-call or billing on-call
AI plane (discovery, validation, scoring, report)	AI on-call
Backend service	Service on-call
Frontend / UI	Web on-call
Data export / deletion	Compliance + Data on-call
Security incident	Security on-call
Customer threatening churn	CSM + Sales Lead

9. Self-serve resources

- Help center — articles indexed and searchable; updated weekly.
- Sample reports — anonymized board reports and briefs.
- Video tutorials — 5–10 minutes each, in the help center.
- Changelog — every release with screenshots.
- Community forum — peer-to-peer, with light moderation.
- Office hours — weekly live Q&A; (Team+).

10. Support metrics

First-response SLA attainment	95%
Resolution SLA attainment	90%
CSAT	4.5/5
NPS (post-resolution)	60+
Tickets per active customer / month	< 0.5
Self-serve deflection rate	50% (Tier 1)
Escalation rate to engineering	< 8%
Median time to resolution (Solo)	24h
Median time to resolution (Team)	6h
Median time to resolution (Enterprise SEV-1)	1h

11.1 Cadence (Enterprise)

- Kickoff — week 1.
- Adoption check-in — week 4.
- First QBR — month 3.
- Quarterly QBRs — ongoing.
- Renewal planning — T-90.

11.2 Health score

- Inputs: logins, reports, integrations, NPS, ticket count.
- Score: green / yellow / red.
- Action: green = nurture; yellow = proactive outreach; red = executive escalation.

11.3 Expansion signals

- Usage trends up → upgrade conversation.
- New use case surfaced → cross-sell.
- Stakeholder expansion → introduce new buyer.

12. Voice & tone

- Empathetic, not patronizing.
- Specific, not generic.
- Confident, not arrogant.
- Concise, not curt.

Tone spectrum:

First contact	Warm, helpful
Bug report	Apologetic, action-oriented
Feature request	Curious, transparent about roadmap
Angry customer	Calm, owning, clear next steps
Resolution	Brief, factual, with a "what's next"

13. Crisis communications

- SEV-1 — within 15 min: status page, in-app banner.
- Email to all affected customers within 1h.
- Postmortem within 7 days; published publicly.
- CSM outreach to all Enterprise customers on the same day.

- Helpdesk: Zendesk.
- Live chat: Intercom (post-MVP) → custom (v2).
- Phone: Dialpad.
- Knowledge base: Zendesk Guide.
- Community: Discourse.
- SLAs: Zendesk + custom monitoring.
- CSM tool: Vitally / Catalyst.
- Surveys: Delighted (CSAT), Wootric (NPS).

15. Appendix

15.1 Revision history

v0.5	2026-07-20	Doc Team	All sections drafted
v1.0	2026-07-20	Doc Team	First approved version

15.2 Cross-references

- Sales Playbook: Document 32.
- Onboarding: Document 37.
- Operations: Document 28.
- Security: Document 21.

End of Document 33 — Customer Support Guide. A good support interaction is itself a feature.